Existence of locally toroidal regular 4-polytopes*

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Abstract

We prove the existence half of Schulte–Weiss Problem 16 (2006) and McMullen–Schulte Conjecture 10C7 (2002): the universal regular 4-polytope $\{\{4,4\}_{(s,0)}, \{4,4\}_{(u,0)}\}$ exists for every pair of distinct odd integers $s, u \geq 3$, with no coprimality assumption. Here $\{4,4\}_{(s,0)}$ is the quotient of the square tessellation by $s\mathbb{Z}^2$. Finiteness and group classification remain open. The proof constructs four matrices over a finite field of characteristic two whose local subgroups are isomorphic to the prescribed toroidal groups. A commutator obstruction shows that these subgroups meet exactly in the subgroup on their two shared generators; this equality lifts to the universal presentation. The group theorem, the geometric identification of the toroidal maps, and the construction and universality of the resulting abstract polytope are formalized in Lean.

1 Introduction

We prove existence for an exceptional family in the classification of locally toroidal regular 4-polytopes. For an integer $p \geq 3$, write $\{4,4\}_{(p,0)}$ for the square tessellation modulo the translation lattice $p\mathbb{Z}^2$. Its vertices are the points of $(\mathbb{Z}/p\mathbb{Z})^2$, with the edges and squares inherited from the unit square grid. For example, $\{4,4\}_{(3,0)}$ has nine vertices and nine square faces. A regular 4-polytope is *locally toroidal* here when both its facets and its vertex-figures are such toroidal maps. The double-brace notation, for example

$$\{\{4,4\}_{(3,0)}, \{4,4\}_{(5,0)}\},$$

denotes the universal regular polytope with the indicated facets and vertex-figures: it covers every regular polytope with those local types. The Schläfli type records the polygon sizes of rank-two sections; type $\{4,4,4\}$ means that all three kinds are squares.

Theorem 1.1. *For every pair of distinct odd integers $s, u \geq 3$, the universal regular 4-polytope*

$$\{\{4,4\}_{(s,0)}, \{4,4\}_{(u,0)}\}$$

exists. It has Schläfli type $\{4,4,4\}$, facets isomorphic to $\{4,4\}_{(s,0)}$, and vertex-figures isomorphic to $\{4,4\}_{(u,0)}$.

McMullen and Schulte recorded the finite universal example with periods $(3,5)$ and its dual [5, pp. 375–376]. Here we establish existence for every pair of distinct odd periods, including pairs

*The proofs, the Lean formalization and the text were produced by AI models (from OpenAI and Anthropic), working under the author's direction. This work has not yet been reviewed by experts.

with common factors. We reuse Coxeter and Moser's toroidal presentations and McMullen and Schulte's reconstruction of regular polytopes from string C-groups (Definition 3.1). The hardest new step is proving that the facet and vertex-figure groups, with independently prescribed periods, meet exactly in their common dihedral subgroup (Proposition 5.3). Realizing the two local maps separately does not establish this equality; the new matrix commutator argument proves it without a coprimality assumption.

This is the existence half of Schulte–Weiss Problem 16 [10, Problem 16] and McMullen–Schulte's 2002 Conjecture 10C7 [5, p. 376]. Finiteness and group classification remain open. There is no gcd restriction: pairs such as $(3, 9)$, $(9, 15)$ and $(15, 45)$ are included. Figure 1 shows the local maps for $(3, 9)$. The theorem does not assert finiteness or infiniteness of the universal polytope for any pair. In particular, the finite matrix group used in the proof is a quotient of the universal polytope's automorphism group. A finite quotient does not decide finiteness of the universal member.

Peter McMullen and Egon Schulte developed the classification of these polytopes in [4] and [5, Chapter 10]. Their book singles out the case of distinct odd periods as exceptional and records the finite example with periods $(3, 5)$ and its dual, crediting G. Havas's coset enumeration and Leytem's group identification [5, pp. 375–376]. Egon Schulte and Asia Ivić Weiss subsequently asked for the classification of this entire family [10]. Their problem includes the group identifications and the conjecture that only $(3, 5)$ and $(5, 3)$ give finite universal members. The present paper addresses the existence assertion throughout the family.

The local presentations are those of H. S. M. Coxeter and W. O. J. Moser [1, Section 8.3]. The passage between groups and regular polytopes uses the theory of string C-groups (Definition 3.1) developed in [5, Section 2E]. Barry Monson and Egon Schulte constructed related locally toroidal polytopes by reduction over finite fields [6]; their type $\{4, 4, 4\}$ construction has equal prime periods on the two sides. Maria Elisa Fernandes and Claudio Alexandre Piedade studied faithful permutation representations of toroidal maps [2] and the related finite universal 4-polytopes [3].

Related constructions prescribe toroidal sections in other settings. Marston D. E. Conder, Yan-Quan Feng and Dong-Dong Hou constructed chiral polytopes of type $\{4, 4, 4\}$ [7]; Gabriel Cunningham, Feng, Hou and Schulte constructed symmetric polytopes whose automorphism groups are 2-groups [8]. Gabe Cunningham and Isabel Hubard developed criteria for polytopality of mixes, including examples with square toroidal facets [9]. These address different symmetry or parameter conditions from the regular polytopes with two prescribed odd periods considered here.

Section 2 explains the strategy. Section 3 sets out the group presentation and the local maps. Section 4 gives the matrices and proves the exact local orders. Section 5 proves the hard intersection equality. Section 6 lifts it to the presented group and constructs the universal polytope. Section 7 describes the scope of the formal proof.

2 Proof overview

We explain how a finite matrix representation establishes existence of the universal polytope, and identify the intersection calculation needed for the proof. The universal candidate is the group on four involutions with the $[4, 4, 4]$ Coxeter relations and the two toroidal period relations, displayed in (4). The question is whether those relations preserve the intended local maps and give the intersection property required of a regular polytope. We prove that they do by constructing a finite matrix image that is faithful on both local groups.

Choose elements λ and μ of orders s and u in one finite field of characteristic two. Their traces $\lambda + \lambda^{-1}$ and $\mu + \mu^{-1}$ determine two parameters in four explicit 4×4 matrices. These matrices satisfy the required relations. The two local translation groups have orders s^2 and u^2; each local

group is the product of its translation group and the common dihedral group of order eight. Thus the local groups have exactly the toroidal orders $8s^2$ and $8u^2$.

The difficult step is to show that the local groups meet only in that dihedral group. Here T, T', V, V' are the translation matrices of (8): the first two are facet translations, and the last two are vertex-figure translations. The matrix T satisfies a quadratic polynomial with two distinct roots, so every power of T lies in the linear span of the identity matrix and T. A particular entry of $TV - VT$ is nonzero. Consequently a power of T that commutes with V must be scalar; oddness forces that power to be the identity. Conjugating by the common dihedral group isolates the two coordinates of an arbitrary facet translation. This proves that the two translation groups intersect trivially. To pass to the full local groups, use that a vertex-figure group modulo its translation subgroup has order eight: the image of an odd-order facet translation in that quotient must be trivial.

Finally, the matrix representation is injective on each local subgroup of the universal presentation, because the toroidal presentation has order at most $8p^2$ and the corresponding matrix image attains that bound. We can therefore pull the intersection equality back to the universal presentation. The string C-group criterion and the coset construction give the universal regular 4-polytope.

3 The group presentation and the toroidal maps

We describe the group whose coset polytope will prove the theorem, and recall why its local presentations specify the intended geometric maps. Throughout this section, p is an odd integer at least three.

An abstract polytope of rank n is a ranked partially ordered set with a least and greatest face, of ranks -1 and n, whose maximal chains (*flags*) contain $n + 2$ faces. It satisfies the diamond condition: exactly two intermediate faces lie between incident faces whose ranks differ by two. It is strongly flag-connected: any two flags can be joined by successive changes of one face, keeping their common faces throughout. It is *regular* if its automorphism group is transitive on flags. A *covering* is a surjective map preserving incidence, rank and adjacency of flags. These are the conventions of [10, Section 2] and [5, Chapter 2].

For example, the standard three reflections of the square grid act by

$$q_0(x, y) = (1 - x, y), \qquad q_1(x, y) = (y, x), \qquad q_2(x, y) = (x, -y). \tag{1}$$

On reducing coordinates modulo p, they act on $\{4, 4\}_{(p,0)}$. The word $q_0q_1q_2q_1$ is translation by $(1, 0)$, and its q_1-conjugate is translation by $(0, 1)$.

Write T_p for the toroidal group below; the subscript distinguishes it from the translation matrix T used later. Its presentation is

$$T_p = \langle q_0, q_1, q_2 \mid q_i^2 = 1,\ (q_0q_1)^4 = (q_1q_2)^4 = (q_0q_2)^2 = 1,\ (q_0q_1q_2q_1)^p = 1 \rangle. \tag{2}$$

The familiar toroidal presentation (2) is the full reflection-group presentation, not just the rotation subgroup [1, Section 8.3]; see also [2, Section 2]. To see its size directly, put $x = q_0q_1q_2q_1$ and $y = q_1xq_1$. The Coxeter relations imply that x, y commute and that

$$q_1xq_1 = y, \quad q_1yq_1 = x, \quad q_2xq_2 = x, \quad q_2yq_2 = y^{-1}.$$

Every element has a form x^iy^jd, where $0 \le i, j < p$ and $d \in \langle q_1, q_2 \rangle$. The latter group has at most eight elements, so $|T_p| \le 8p^2$. Conversely, the affine action (1) contains all p^2 translations and the

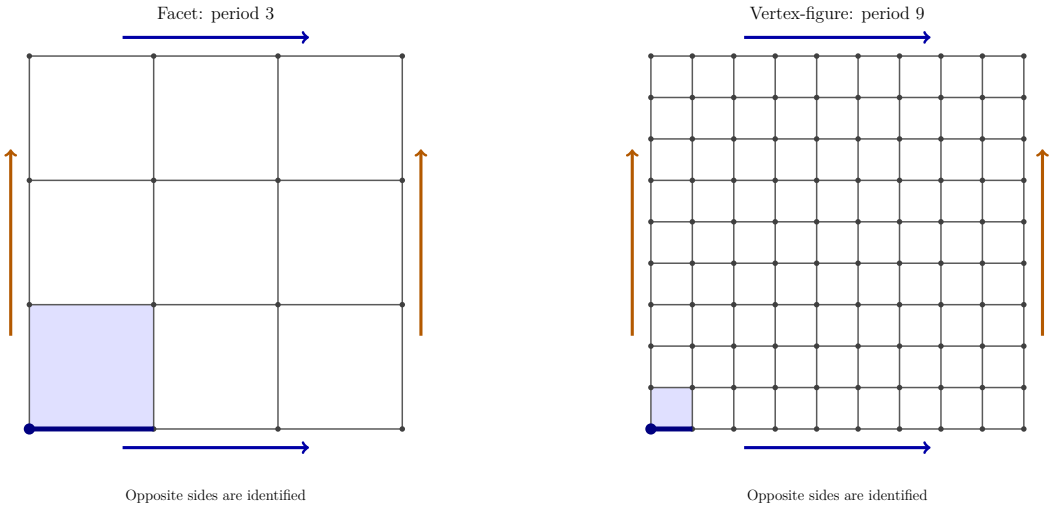


Figure 1: The facet map $\{4,4\}_{(3,0)}$ and vertex-figure map $\{4,4\}_{(9,0)}$ for the $(3,9)$ instance of Theorem 1.1, drawn as fundamental domains of the square tessellation. Identify the opposite sides in the directions of the matching arrows. Boundary vertices are repeated representatives of the same torus vertices. The shaded square, thick edge and marked vertex form a base flag. The panels depict the two local maps of the universal regular 4-polytope. The drawing is generated from their vertex, edge and square data, checked against the grid-quotient definition identified here with the coset map of T_p.

eight signed coordinate permutations. For $p \geq 3$ these are distinct, so $|T_p| = 8p^2$ and the action is faithful.

The stabilizers of the base vertex $(0,0)$, the base edge from $(0,0)$ to $(1,0)$, and the base unit square are respectively $\langle q_1, q_2\rangle$, $\langle q_0, q_2\rangle$ and $\langle q_0, q_1\rangle$, as the normal form verifies. The induced coset-to-face bijections preserve incidence and rank, so the coset polytope of T_p is the square tessellation quotient $\{4,4\}_{(p,0)}$.

For a group generated by $g_0, \ldots, g_{n-1}$, put $G_I = \langle g_i : i \in I\rangle$ for each subset I of the index set. An involution is a nonidentity group element whose square is the identity; in particular, the distinguished involutions below satisfy $g_i^2 = 1$.

Definition 3.1. A group $G = \langle g_0, \ldots, g_{n-1}\rangle$ with distinguished involutions is a *string C-group* if $g_i g_j = g_j g_i$ whenever $|i-j| \geq 2$, and

$$G_I \cap G_J = G_{I\cap J} \qquad (I, J \subseteq \{0, \ldots, n-1\}). \tag{3}$$

The generators of T_p have this property: the square torus is a regular polytope, and the distinguished generators of any regular polytope satisfy the string relations and intersection property [10, Section 2]. Here their affine action was identified with the full torus group above. String C-groups reconstruct regular polytopes [5, Theorem 2E11]. We will use the rank-four criterion: if the subgroups on g_0, g_1, g_2 and on g_1, g_2, g_3 are string C-groups and meet in $\langle g_1, g_2\rangle$, the string relations imply (3) for all subsets [5, Proposition 2E16].

Define the universal candidate by

$$\begin{aligned}\Gamma(s,u) = \langle r_0, r_1, r_2, r_3 \mid\ & r_i^2 = 1 \ (0 \le i \le 3),\\ & (r_0 r_1)^4 = (r_1 r_2)^4 = (r_2 r_3)^4 = 1,\\ & (r_0 r_2)^2 = (r_0 r_3)^2 = (r_1 r_3)^2 = 1,\\ & (r_0 r_1 r_2 r_1)^s = (r_1 r_2 r_3 r_2)^u = 1\rangle.\end{aligned} \tag{4}$$

We must prove that its local groups are T_s, T_u and that it is a string C-group; neither conclusion follows merely by writing down the relators.

4 An explicit matrix construction

We now construct the finite image of (4) and calculate its local groups. Fix distinct odd integers $s, u \ge 3$ for the remainder of the proof. All matrix entries in this section belong to a finite field K of characteristic two. The notation $\mathbf{1}$ denotes the 4×4 identity matrix; the letters I, J in Definition 3.1 denote index sets only.

4.1 Parameters and generators

We choose a common finite field and parameters encoding the two prescribed periods, then define the four generators. Let $k = \varphi(su)$, where φ is Euler's totient function, and choose $K = \mathbb{F}_{2^k}$. Since su is odd, Euler's theorem gives $su \mid 2^k - 1$. The cyclic group $K^\times$ therefore contains elements λ, μ of exact orders s, u. Set

$$\sigma = \lambda + \lambda^{-1}, \qquad \tau = \mu + \mu^{-1}, \qquad a = \frac{\sigma^2}{\tau}, \qquad b = \sigma + a. \tag{5}$$

These parameters satisfy

$$\sigma\tau ab \neq 0, \qquad a + b = \sigma, \qquad (a+b)^2/a = \tau. \tag{6}$$

Indeed, either trace is zero only if the corresponding element has square one. Equality of the two traces would give $(\mu - \lambda)(\mu - \lambda^{-1}) = 0$, contradicting their distinct orders. Hence $b = \sigma(\tau + \sigma)/\tau$ is nonzero too. This choice of field uses no coprimality between s and u.

For $c \in K$ define $R(c)$, and then the four generators, by

$$\begin{aligned} R(c) &= \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 & 0 \\ c & 0 & 1 & 1 \\ 0 & c & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}, \qquad \rho_0 = R(a), \quad \rho_2 = R(b),\\ \rho_1 &= \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}, \qquad \rho_3 = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 0 & 0 & a^{-1} \\ 0 & 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 0 \\ a & 0 & 0 & 0 \end{pmatrix}. \end{aligned} \tag{7}$$

They are invertible because their squares are $\mathbf{1}$. Put $\Lambda = \langle \rho_0, \rho_1, \rho_2, \rho_3 \rangle \le \mathrm{GL}_4(K)$. Direct multiplication gives the string relations and the three adjacent fourth-power relations. Each adjacent product has order exactly four: using indices $1, 2, 3, 4$, the $(1,1)$ entries of $(\rho_0\rho_1)^2 - \mathbf{1}$ and $(\rho_1\rho_2)^2 - \mathbf{1}$ are a, b, while the $(1,2)$ entry of $(\rho_2\rho_3)^2 - \mathbf{1}$ is σ/a. All three are nonzero.

4.2 Translation orders and independent directions

We prove that each local group has two independent translation directions of the prescribed order. Define the translations and their subgroups by

$$\begin{gathered} T = \rho_0\rho_1\rho_2\rho_1, \quad T' = \rho_1 T \rho_1, \qquad V = \rho_1\rho_2\rho_3\rho_2, \quad V' = \rho_2 V \rho_2, \\ A = \langle T, T' \rangle, \qquad B = \langle V, V' \rangle, \qquad D = \langle \rho_1, \rho_2 \rangle, \\ F = \langle \rho_0, \rho_1, \rho_2 \rangle, \qquad E = \langle \rho_1, \rho_2, \rho_3 \rangle. \end{gathered} \tag{8}$$

For the fixed trace parameter τ from (5), put $q_\tau(X) = X^2 + \tau X + 1$. Evaluating this polynomial at a matrix M gives $q_\tau(M) = M^2 + \tau M + \mathbf{1}$. The polynomial q_τ is distinct notation from the reflections q_0, q_1, q_2 of Section 3. The identities in Appendix A, together with the explicit matrices there, give the calculations needed for the following proof.

Lemma 4.1. *For the matrices (7) with parameters (5), the elements T, T' have order s, the elements V, V' have order u, and*

$$A \cong C_s \times C_s, \qquad B \cong C_u \times C_u,$$

where C_p denotes a cyclic group of order p.

Proof. The polynomial $X^2 + \sigma X + 1$ has distinct roots λ, λ^{-1}. The matrix T is nonscalar: its $(1,3)$ entry is one. Thus its minimal polynomial is this quadratic. It follows that T has order s, and conjugation gives the same order for T'. Likewise V is annihilated by the squarefree polynomial

$$(X - 1)(X - \mu)(X - \mu^{-1}).$$

Since $V \neq \mathbf{1}$, its minimal polynomial has at least one of the roots μ, μ^{-1} as well as, possibly, 1. Its order is therefore u. Conjugation gives the same order for V'.

To prove independence of the two facet directions, observe that $\mathbf{1}, T, T'$ are linearly independent. Indeed, the $(1,3)$, $(2,1)$ and $(1,1)$ entries of $\alpha\mathbf{1} + \beta T + \gamma T' = 0$ give successively $\gamma = \beta$, $\sigma\beta = 0$ and $\alpha = 0$. Every power of T belongs to $K\mathbf{1} + KT$, by its quadratic relation; similarly powers of T' belong to $K\mathbf{1} + KT'$. If $T^i(T')^j = \mathbf{1}$, then $T^i = (T')^{-j}$ lies in the intersection of these two planes and is scalar. Evaluating a scalar power at both roots gives $\lambda^i = \lambda^{-i}$. Since s is odd, this forces $s \mid i$, and then $s \mid j$. The commuting generators consequently give $A \cong C_s \times C_s$.

For the vertex directions, put $W = q_\tau(V)$. The identities (12) give $W \neq 0$, $VW = W$ and $q_\tau(V')W = 0$. If $V^i(V')^j = \mathbf{1}$, commutation implies $(V')^j W = W$. The polynomial $q_\tau(X)$ has roots μ, μ^{-1}. If $u \nmid j$, then $q_\tau(X)$ and $X^j - 1$ are coprime. Evaluating a Bézout identity at V' and multiplying by W would give $W = 0$, a contradiction: both polynomial summands annihilate W by the two identities above. Thus $u \mid j$, and the order of V then gives $u \mid i$. This proves $B \cong C_u \times C_u$. □

Proposition 4.2. *For the matrices (7), the assignments $q_i \mapsto \rho_i$ and $q_i \mapsto \rho_{i+1}$ give isomorphisms $T_s \cong F$ and $T_u \cong E$, respectively. Both preserve the distinguished generators, and $|F| = 8s^2$, $|E| = 8u^2$. Moreover $F = A \rtimes D$ and $E = B \rtimes D$, with $|D| = 8$.*

Proof. The product $\rho_1\rho_2$ has order four, so D is dihedral of order eight. The conjugation identities are

	T	T'	V	V'
$\rho_1(\cdot)\rho_1$	T'	T	V^{-1}	V'
$\rho_2(\cdot)\rho_2$	T	$(T')^{-1}$	V'	V

(9)

and show that D normalizes A and B. The identities

$$\rho_0 = T\rho_1\rho_2\rho_1, \qquad \rho_3 = \rho_2\rho_1 V\rho_2$$

show that $F = AD$ and $E = BD$. The odd orders $|A| = s^2$ and $|B| = u^2$ imply $A \cap D = B \cap D = 1$. This gives the asserted orders and semidirect products. Finally the local relations induce surjections $T_s \to F$ and $T_u \to E$. The bound $|T_p| \leq 8p^2$ from Section 3, together with the image orders just proved, makes both maps isomorphisms. □

5 The local intersection

We prove $F \cap E = D$. The local groups have the required sizes, but that does not by itself control their intersection. The following commutator obstruction is the reason that shared divisors of s and u cause no problem.

Lemma 5.1. *For the matrices (7) with parameters (5), if $n \geq 0$ and $T^nV = VT^n$, then $s \mid n$.*

Proof. The quadratic relation for T gives scalars $\alpha, \beta \in K$ with

$$T^n = \alpha\mathbf{1} + \beta T, \qquad \lambda^n = \alpha + \beta\lambda, \qquad \lambda^{-n} = \alpha + \beta\lambda^{-1}. \tag{10}$$

These formulas follow simultaneously by induction, using the same quadratic relation for T, λ, λ^{-1}. Commuting the first formula with V gives $\beta(TV - VT) = 0$. But direct multiplication gives

$$(TV - VT)_{12} = \sigma/a \neq 0. \tag{11}$$

Hence $\beta = 0$. The remaining formulas in (10) give $\lambda^n = \lambda^{-n}$, so $s \mid 2n$. Since s is odd, $s \mid n$, as required. □

Lemma 5.2. *For the translation subgroups A, B in (8), with parameters (5), one has $A \cap B = 1$.*

Proof. Let $z \in A \cap B$ and write $z = T^i(T')^j$, with $0 \leq i, j < s$. Conjugation by ρ_2 fixes T and inverts T', so

$$z(\rho_2 z\rho_2) = T^{2i}, \qquad z(\rho_2 z\rho_2)^{-1} = (T')^{2j}.$$

Both elements belong to B, since D normalizes B. Conjugating the second one by ρ_1 shows that $T^{2j} \in B$ too. The group B is abelian and contains V. Thus T^{2i} and T^{2j} commute with V. Lemma 5.1 gives $s \mid 2i$ and $s \mid 2j$. Oddness of s gives $s \mid i, j$, whence $z = \mathbf{1}$. □

Proposition 5.3. *For the local matrix groups F, E, D in (8), with parameters (5), one has*

$$F \cap E = D.$$

Proof. The inclusion $D \subseteq F \cap E$ is immediate. For the reverse inclusion, let $z \in F \cap E$. Write $z = td$ with $t \in A$ and $d \in D$, using Proposition 4.2. Then $t = zd^{-1} \in E$. Its order is odd, because $|A| = s^2$ is odd. But B is normal in E, and $|E/B| = 8$. The image of t in E/B has order dividing both eight and an odd number; it is therefore trivial. Thus $t \in B$. Lemma 5.2 now gives $t = \mathbf{1}$, so $z = d \in D$. □

This argument never compares divisors of s with divisors of u. The only cancellations are by two in the facet period, and by a power of two in a quotient of the vertex-figure group. Coprimality of the two periods is unnecessary.

The local isomorphisms of Proposition 4.2 and the rank-four criterion also show that Λ is a string C-group. Because its matrices are over a finite field, its coset polytope is a finite regular 4-polytope with facets $\{4,4\}_{(s,0)}$ and vertex-figures $\{4,4\}_{(u,0)}$. This gives a finite realization for every pair in the theorem. The next section concerns the universal member, whose group maps onto Λ and need not be identified with it.

6 The universal group and polytope

We transfer the intersection calculation from the finite matrix image to the full presentation (4), then recover its faces and universal covering property.

Theorem 6.1. *Let $s, u \geq 3$ be distinct odd integers, and let $\Gamma(s,u)$ be the group with exactly the presentation (4). Its distinguished generators form a string C-group, and all three adjacent products have order exactly four. The homomorphisms from (2) give distinguished-generator-preserving isomorphisms*

$$T_s \cong \langle r_0, r_1, r_2 \rangle, \qquad T_u \cong \langle r_1, r_2, r_3 \rangle.$$

These subgroups have orders $8s^2$ and $8u^2$, respectively.

Proof. The matrix relations and Lemma 4.1 give an epimorphism $\pi : \Gamma(s,u) \to \Lambda$ with $\pi(r_i) = \rho_i$. Put $\widehat{F} = \langle r_0, r_1, r_2 \rangle$, $\widehat{E} = \langle r_1, r_2, r_3 \rangle$ and $\widehat{D} = \langle r_1, r_2 \rangle$. There are surjections $T_s \to \widehat{F} \to F$ and $T_u \to \widehat{E} \to E$. The composed maps $T_s \to F$ and $T_u \to E$ are exactly the generator-preserving isomorphisms of Proposition 4.2. Hence each map in the two chains is an isomorphism, and π is injective on both $\widehat{F}$ and $\widehat{E}$. In particular, both are string C-groups with the displayed generators.

If $z \in \widehat{F} \cap \widehat{E}$, then $\pi(z) \in F \cap E = D = \pi(\widehat{D})$. Choose $d \in \widehat{D}$ with $\pi(z) = \pi(d)$. Both z, d lie in $\widehat{F}$, where π is injective. Thus $z = d$, proving $\widehat{F} \cap \widehat{E} = \widehat{D}$. The rank-four criterion recalled in Section 3 now proves the intersection property for every pair of index subsets. The string relations already hold in the presentation. Finally the adjacent products have fourth power one in $\Gamma(s,u)$ and images of order four in Λ, so their orders are exactly four. Each generator is consequently a nonidentity involution. □

Proof of Theorem 1.1. Let $\Gamma = \Gamma(s,u)$. For $i = 0,1,2,3$ put $H_i = \langle r_j : j \neq i \rangle$. The proper faces of rank i are the left cosets gH_i. Two proper faces of different ranks are incident if their cosets meet; orient this incidence by rank, and adjoin a least face of rank -1 and a greatest face of rank 4. This is the coset construction $P(\Gamma)$ of [5, Section 2E]. Theorem 6.1 supplies the string C-group hypotheses, so the construction is a regular 4-polytope.

By the reconstruction theorem [5, Theorem 2E11], left multiplication identifies Γ with the full automorphism group, acting simply transitively on flags.

The facets are the coset polytopes of $\widehat{F}$, and the vertex-figures those of $\widehat{E}$. Their generator-preserving identifications with T_s, T_u show that they are $\{4,4\}_{(s,0)}, \{4,4\}_{(u,0)}$, with the geometric meanings established in Section 3. Exact adjacent orders give Schläfli type $\{4,4,4\}$.

It remains to check universality. Let Q be any regular 4-polytope with these facets and vertex-figures, and choose a base flag. Its distinguished involutions satisfy the Coxeter relations of (4). The two local types imply the two additional period relations. Thus r_i may be sent to the corresponding distinguished involution of Q, giving a surjection $\Gamma \to \mathrm{Aut}(Q)$, where $\mathrm{Aut}(Q)$ is the group of order automorphisms of Q, meaning bijections preserving its partial order in both directions. On cosets,

this sends gH_i to the image under g of the base face of rank i of Q. It is well-defined because every generator of H_i fixes that face. The map is surjective and preserves rank, incidence and flag adjacency, so it is a covering. Therefore $P(\Gamma)$ is the universal member $\{\{4,4\}_{(s,0)},\{4,4\}_{(u,0)}\}$, as asserted. This is the universal construction of [5, Theorem 4A2] in this particular class. □

7 Formalization

The accompanying Lean proof establishes the group and geometric polytope conclusions from their definitions. It includes the finite-field choice, the local orders, the full intersection property, and the transfer to the universal presentation. The square torus is defined independently of a group as the vertex sets of grid faces modulo $p\mathbb{Z}^2$, ordered by inclusion; the proof identifies it with the local coset polytope. Regularity, the full automorphism group, and the universal covering property are also included.

The formal group theorem asserts the exact presentation, the full intersection property, and the two generator-preserving local isomorphisms. The formal geometric theorem constructs the regular polytope with the specified square-torus sections and its covering onto every regular polytope with those local sections.[1] Trust rests on the Lean kernel and the stated foundational definitions.

Appendix A Matrix calculations

We give the explicit translation matrices and collect the multiplication identities used in Section 4. The notation is that of (5) and (8); in particular, $\sigma = a + b$ and $\tau = (a + b)^2/a$. Expanding the products in (8) gives

$$T = \begin{pmatrix} 1+b & 0 & 1 & 1 \\ b & 1 & 0 & 1 \\ \sigma & \sigma & 1+\sigma & 0 \\ ab & \sigma & b & 1+a \end{pmatrix}, \qquad V = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & \sigma/a & 0 & a^{-1} \\ \sigma & 1+\tau & 1 & \sigma/a \\ \sigma & \tau & 1 & \sigma/a \\ a & \sigma & 0 & 0 \end{pmatrix}.$$

The quadratic expression used to separate the vertex translations is

$$q_\tau(V) = V^2 + \tau V + \mathbf{1} = \begin{pmatrix} \tau & 0 & \sigma/a & 0 \\ \sigma & 0 & 0 & \sigma/a \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & \sigma & \tau \end{pmatrix}.$$

With $T' = \rho_1 T \rho_1$ and $V' = \rho_2 V \rho_2$, multiplication gives the entries $(T')_{13} = 1$, $(T')_{21} = a$ and $(T')_{11} = 1 + b$ used to check independence in Lemma 4.1, and the identities

$$\begin{gathered} T^2 = \sigma T + \mathbf{1}, \qquad (T')^2 = \sigma T' + \mathbf{1}, \qquad TT' = T'T, \\ VV' = V'V, \qquad (V+\mathbf{1})q_\tau(V) = 0, \qquad (V'+\mathbf{1})q_\tau(V') = 0, \\ q_\tau(V')q_\tau(V) = 0, \qquad (q_\tau(V))_{11} = \tau, \qquad V \neq \mathbf{1}. \end{gathered} \tag{12}$$

These are identities in characteristic two with the parameter relations (6). The displayed matrices exhibit $T_{13} = 1$, $V_{11} = 0$ and $(q_\tau(V))_{11} = \tau \neq 0$, which are the nonvanishing entries used in Lemma 4.1.

[1] The corresponding declarations are `P16c.Main.p16c` and `P16c.p16c_polytope_geometric`, respectively. Their proofs use only `propext`, `Classical.choice` and `Quot.sound`.

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